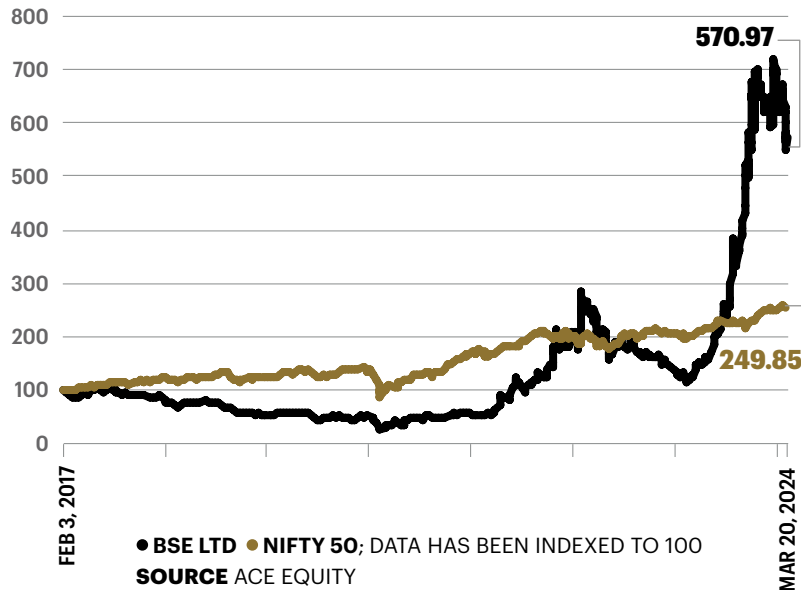


FAR AHEAD

► 2023 was the best year for BSE shares in terms of performance

► The current calendar year, though, has been lacklustre so far



“We are public infrastructure, and we have to work for public interest and not our interest. NSE and BSE are not competing as all the companies are listed on both the exchanges, the same set of regulations apply to both the exchanges and even the brokers and investors are the same on both the exchanges,” Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD & CEO of NSE, had told *Business Today* in an exclusive interview in November last year. Chauhan, too, is a former BSE MD & CEO.

“The society requires many more players. I believe that even monopolies that are designed for public good may not remain good for very long. There is a lot of co-operation, and the competition would be just 0.001 per cent,” the NSE boss had said.

Ramamurthy agrees. “We are not competing, we are comple-



“If the market share in any segment is highly skewed then it poses a systemic risk to the entire capital markets. The way the BSE F&O segment is developing, I think it is going in the right direction”

RAJNICKANT PATEL
FORMER BSE CEO AND CO-FOUNDER, RUHN GLOBAL ADVISORY LLP

menting [each other]. We have clearly proved in derivatives that we are complementing [each other]. In the cash market also, the pie will grow. Think of the cost reduction when liquidity improves,” he says.

THE ROAD AHEAD

BSE’s gain in market share in the derivatives arena may well have grabbed headlines but that is just one tiny spoke in a big wheel and Ramamurthy is well aware of that. Going forward, he aims to make BSE a more vibrant exchange not just in the cash and derivatives segments but also in the small and medium enterprises (SME) and mutual funds (MF) arena. His key focus areas include ensuring that the growth is deeper and sustainable.

“SME and MF are close to my heart. We need to go to the quality SMEs and tell them the benefits of listing and bring them in while creating a vibrant [and] active fundraising platform with proper visibility. MFs have a very important role to play in wealth building and diversion of a portion of savings into physical assets to financial assets,” he explains.

BSE is doing fairly well in both these segments—nearly 500 SMEs have listed on the exchange and its MF platform has been consistently setting new records in terms of the number of transactions—but Ramamurthy knows that the processes need to be designed and implemented in a manner that stands the test of time. And only the first steps have been taken.

People will come and go but what is important is that BSE should continue to grow, sums up Ramamurthy. With the priorities set right, Asia’s oldest exchange can look forward to better days ahead. **BT**

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